

EDUCATION

2019 - 2025 2020	University of California, Los Angeles	Ph.D. in Psychology (Computational Cognition) M.A. in Psychology (Computational Cognition)
2013 - 2015	University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	B.S. with Honors Majors: 1 Computer Science, 2 Biopsychology, Cognition & Neuroscience
2012 - 2013	University of Minnesota (Exchange Program)	
2010 - 2012	Beijing Normal University (Transferred)	

WORK EXPERIENCE

2025 - now	AI Research Scientist	Intel
• Researching and implementing start-of-the-art methods of context engineering for AI agents.		

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS & HONORS

2024	Charles E. and Sue K. Young Graduate Student Fellowship Award (UCLA)	
2024	Dissertation Year Award (UCLA)	
2022	Division Recognition Award (Intel Labs)	
2022	CVPR Best Demo Award [†]	
2022	CVPR Travel Award	
2022	Liu Yunghuo Bei Qui Memorial Fellowship (UCLA)	
2021	Harold H. Kelley Award for Best Basic Research Paper (UCLA Psychology) [‡]	
2020	Debug 2020 Summit Scholarship	
2020	Grace Hopper Celebration Scholarship	
2019	NeurIPS Travel Award	
2019	Methods in Neuroscience at Dartmouth (MIND) Computational Summer School Fellow	
2015	LSA Honors Grants for Research, Travel, and Special Projects (Univ. of Michigan)	
2013 - 2015	University Honors (Univ. of Michigan)	
2012 - 2013	Dean's List (Univ. of Minnesota)	
2012	Study Abroad Foundation Scholarship	

PUBLICATIONS

Schwyck, M. E., **Du, M.**, Parkinson, C. (2025). The role of one's own social network position in learning new networks: Brokerage is associated with better network learning. *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*.

- Tang, J., **Du, M.**, Vo, V. A., Lal, V., Huth, A. G. (2023). Brain encoding models based on multimodal transformers can transfer across language and vision. *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*.
- Baek, E., Hyon, R., Lopez, K., **Du, M.**, Porter, M., Parkinson, C. (2023). Lonely individuals process the world in idiosyncratic ways. *Psychological Science*.
- [†] **Du, M.***, Aflalo, E.*, Tseng, S. Y., Liu, Y., Wu, C., Duan, N., & Lal, V. (2022). VL-InterpreT: an interactive visualization tool for interpreting vision-language transformers. *Proceedings of the IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR)*.
- Du, M.***, Schwyck, M. E.*, Li, Y., Chang, L. J., Parkinson, C. (2022). Similarity among friends serves as a social prior: the assumption that "birds of a feather flock together" shapes social decisions and relationship beliefs. *Personality and Social Psychology Bulletin*.
- Schwych, M. E., **Du, M.**, Natarajan, P., Chwe, J. A., & Parkinson, C. (2022). Neural encoding of novel social networks: evidence that perceivers prioritize others' centrality. *Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience*.
- Du, M.**, Parkinson, C. (2021). Navigating social knowledge. *Nature Neuroscience*, 24(9), 1195-1197.
- [‡] **Du, M.**, Basyouni, R., Parkinson, C. (2021). How does the brain navigate knowledge of social relations? Testing for shared neural mechanisms for shifting attention in space and social knowledge. *NeuroImage*.
- Parkinson, C., & **Du, M.** (2020). How does the brain Infer hidden social structures?. *Trends in Cognitive Sciences*.
- Lieberman, M. D., Straccia, M. A., Meyer, M. L., **Du, M.** & Tan, K. M. (2019). Social, self, (situational), and affective processes in medial prefrontal cortex (MPFC): Causal, multivariate, and reverse inference evidence. *Neuroscience & Biobehavioral Reviews*.

PREPRINTS & FORTHCOMING

- Du, M.**, Blank, I., Parkinson, C. (in revision). Social Cognition in Artificial and Biological Neural Networks.

TEACHING & SERVICE

2021 - now **Ad-hoc Reviewer**

Journals: Nature Communications, eLife, Journal of Neuroscience, PLOS Biology, Scientific Reports, Social Cognitive and Affective Neuroscience, Neuropsychologia, Oxford Open Neuroscience, STAR Protocols

Conferences: CVPR 2026, NeurIPS 2026, ECCV 2026, Society for Personality and Social Psychology Annual Convention (SPSP 2025)

Workshops: NeurIPS Women in Machine Learning Workshop (2023, 2024), NeurIPS New In ML Workshop (2023), ICLR Re-Align Workshop (2024, 2025, 2026)

- 2021 **Teaching Assistant / Guest Lecturer** Psych 137: Neuroscience of Social Perception (UCLA)
- 2020 **Teaching Assistant** Computational Neuroscience Course (Neuromatch Academy)
- 2020 **Teaching Assistant** Psych 10: Introductory Psychology (UCLA)